

When work on *Apollon* began in the spring semester of 2010, no one was sure whether there would even be a first issue. The challenges of building an ejournal were initially overwhelming. We fretted over funding, honed our project pitching skills, and designed an online portal to house the finished product without knowing whether our efforts would come to fruition in the form of a polished and presentable first issue.

Fortunately, our efforts were met with great enthusiasm from our participating institutions, and most importantly, from students. *Apollon* is a student-designed and student-led journal, motivated by the process of creating the journal and subsequently, submitting student work to cross-institutional peer-reviewing. Beyond the production of the journal and all of the challenges its completion presents, quality undergraduate research and scholarship in the humanities was the mission underscoring the creation of *Apollon* and the reason we can proudly present this inaugural issue.

Our first issue presents four excellent and diverse examples of undergraduate humanities research, which were each selected for their interesting use of research, media, and format. When Katherine Jansen, a recent graduate of Randolph College, submitted her play *The Jurymen*, a thoughtful and funny rendering of the historical record of the Ancient Greek philosophers Socrates and Plato, we were convinced to overlook our word limit and decided to feature her work in this first issue. Marriah Redden's paper *Moby-dick and the Color of the Elusive* examines Melville's classic work through Saussurian structuralism and the analysis of language and its signifiers. Marriah's exploration of the symbolic use of color to decode Melville's complex ideas toward society, religion, and race is an excellent example of undergraduate scholarship. Third, we are proud to present Sean Owlsey's study of the modern break-up, *IT'S ALL YOUR...wait...no, we're both to blame: A Look at Relational Rialectics Within a Modern Breakup*. Sean's analysis of the film (500) *Days of Summer* to provides a commentary on relationships through the lens of Relational Dialectics Theory. At its core, it's also an excellent critical interpretation of a complex movie. *Black Sabbath*, a painting by Philip Johnson, is the work of art behind Victoria Winfree's paper of the same name. Winfree suggests that the painting is a "bittersweet homage of the passing of girlhood," and compares its message to those given by other famous paintings of the 20th century, including *Girls by Stream* by Racham. She captures the strokes of the artist through her words, and pays an ideal tribute to the magnificent painting, *Black Sabbath*.

Within this body of exceptional work, we traveled back to the time the ancient philosophers in Greece and saw new colors and meanings in the 20th classic *Moby Dick*. We perceived the beauty and subtleties of 20th and 21st Century artwork and examined through a recent and popular film the complexities of the modern break-up. It was our hope that the work submitted would be representative of a variety of media, formats, and time periods, and we feel strongly that our hopes have been realized. The diversity of both topic and format is representative of the interests and questions which undergraduates are grappling with. Where history and modernity collide is a theme which was highlighted in this issue's pieces, as well as the creative opportunities

presented by the multitude of media options in our technological age. *Apollon* strives to seize these opportunities, through welcoming creative works which are grounded in research and research which breaks free of its traditional text-and-paper chains. We invite submissions which challenge traditional notions of research and aim to take further advantage of the unique opportunities presented by the ejournal format.

In presenting the inaugural issue of *Apollon*, we have many individuals and affiliates to which we give our most profound thanks for their time and effort in enabling us to develop this project. Student work and collaboration have made this possible. Many thanks to our student reviewers, Kelly, Charles, Meagan, and Austin, the web site crew, Ryan Camenish and Andrew Smith, Travis Jones for the logo design, and Rose Cale, who dedicated many hours to helping realize the project. Also, faculty (insert here) and institutions (colleges, ACA).

We hope to have expressed how excited we are for the future of *Apollon*, and we hope that you will get involved in this project. There are several ways, including submitting your work! Our submission deadline for the next issue is January 30th, 2011. If you would like to work on the editorial board or review work for publication, or engage at any step of the process, we would love to hear from you!

Mollie Harris & Bishen Sen